AS **Aqil Shah Ayaz**
DATA ANALYST · MEL EXPERT

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Data Analyst · Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (MEL) Expert

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SUMMARY

Data analyst and MEL specialist with more than 10 years of experience turning program and field data into dashboards, evaluations and reports for USAID, UN agencies, the World Bank, FCDO, the EU, SIDA and the U.S. Department of Defense. Builds end-to-end data systems from survey design and digital data collection through cleaning, statistical analysis and Power BI or Tableau reporting. Contributed to 55+ evaluation and third-party monitoring assignments, authored 100+ analytical reports, managed 40,000+ field interviews and trained 500+ staff. Has led core teams of up to 16 staff and 500+ field staff, and 5 to 15 direct reports on consulting teams. Certified in Power BI (PL-300) and SQL (Oracle). Holds an MBA, with deep experience in health data.

SKILLS

Analysis	Python (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, statsmodels), R, SQL, MySQL, Stata, SPSS, SAS, Excel (Power Query, pivot tables); regression, sampling and weighting, hypothesis testing
BI and visualization	Power BI (DAX, Power Query, data modeling, row-level security), Tableau, ArcGIS, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Canva, Visme, Napkin AI
AI tools	ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Claude, Gemini, Grok; AI-assisted coding, QA and report drafting, with care for sensitive data
MEL methods	MEL and MEAL frameworks, theory of change, logframes, indicator design (PIRS), OECD/DAC evaluation, third-party monitoring, data quality assessment, mixed methods
Qualitative	ATLAS.ti, NVivo, thematic coding, key informant interviews, focus group discussions
Data collection	KoBo Toolbox, SurveyCTO, ODK, Survey123, CommCare, DHIS2
Platforms and tools	Salesforce, dbt, SharePoint, Microsoft 365, Google Workspace, Jira, ClickUp, Basecamp, Slack, Miro

PORTFOLIO (INTERACTIVE DASHBOARDS WITH CODE)

- Third-Party Monitoring Site-Visit Tracker: Python ETL, SQL, DAX measures
- Food Security and Resilience Evaluation: R (FCS, rCSI, MDD-W, logistic regression)
- Radio-Based Literacy Learning Assessment: Python, SPSS (item analysis, KR-20)
- Girls in STEM Endline Evaluation: Python, Stata (paired t-test, fixed effects)
- Workplace Safety Before-and-After Assessment: Python (McNemar test)
- Literacy Classes TPM Partner Scorecard: KoBo Toolbox, Python (spot checks, learner assessment)
- Mine Action MEL Evidence Matrix: Python, qualitative coding (OECD/DAC criteria)
- Women's Advocacy Outcome Tracking: Python (Wilcoxon test, outcome harvesting)
- Teacher Training Needs Assessment: Python (KII scoring and selection rule)
- Training delivered and proposals developed: aqilshah-researcher.github.io/expertise/capacity-building
- Third-party monitoring, evaluations and assessments: aqilshah-researcher.github.io/case-studies

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Systems and M&E Advisor Nov 2022 – Mar 2025

Management Systems International (MSI) · Remote

1 direct report **4** data collection partners coordinated and trained

- With the TPM team, built Python (pandas, NumPy) pipelines that cut monthly third-party monitoring processing by about 60 percent (20 to 8 analyst hours) across 10 active USAID projects.
- Managed the full TPM data flow from Survey123 to Python ETL to Power BI with row-level security, surfacing yellow and red flags for USAID mission leadership.
- Managed TPM assignments for USAID health projects AFIAT and UHI, using sampling to set monthly and weekly health facility visit schedules.
- Served as the main link to four national data collection partners (Malan, Ideal Impact, Integrity Watch Afghanistan and ACSOR) and trained their field staff on tools, protocols and data quality.
- Trained and mentored 100+ MEAL officers and partner staff on Power BI, digital data collection and data quality.

Senior Research, Data and M&E Project Manager Nov 2021 – Sep 2022

Adroit Associates · Kabul

16 core staff led directly **300+** field staff led through supervisors

- Managed collection of 40,000+ field interviews with the field and data teams, using automated R validation for FAO, ILO, UNDP and ACTED evaluations and TPM.
- Coded about 124 interview transcripts a month in ATLAS.ti for mixed-methods reports; managed budgets, workplans and vendors.

Power BI Data Analyst and M&E Manager Oct 2019 – Aug 2021

TAGHEER Mosbat Consultancy · Kabul

13 core staff led directly **200+** field staff led through supervisors **+** subject matter experts on some assignments

- With the team, built Power BI dashboards for 17+ donor portfolios including the State Department, UNESCO, UNICEF, UNHCR, Save the Children and Oxfam.
- Designed an organization-wide data governance framework and MySQL cleaning workflows with guidance from the CEO; trained 56+ staff; contributed to 18 evaluation, monitoring and research assignments.

Data Management and Regional M&E Coordinator Jan 2015 – May 2019

Afghanistan Center for Excellence (ACE) · East Zone

2 assistants supervised

- Worked with program leadership to design monitoring systems and Power BI and Tableau dashboards for USAID, DOD, UNDP, ERRIN and DAI-subcontracted projects.
- Supervised two M&E assistants and coordinated monitoring of 12 job placement, training and women's economic empowerment programs; trained 50+ field staff.

Data Management and M&E Assistant Jul 2014 – Dec 2014

Humanitarian Assistance and Development Association for Afghanistan (HADAAF) · Nangarhar

- Managed DHIS2 and Excel health facility data for WHO, IMC and BRAC-funded BPHS programs, with discrepancy analysis for reporting.

CONSULTING ENGAGEMENTS

Led consulting teams of 5 to 15 people reporting directly, including at Search for Common Ground.

- **Proposal Writer (Monitoring, Evaluation and Data)**, Kudos Afghanistan (proposals for the World Bank, UNESCO, UN Women, WFP, IOM and other donors) (Oct 2026 – Present)
- **Data Analytics and Lead Evaluation Consultant**, Search for Common Ground (SIDA-funded evaluation) (Sep – Nov 2025)
- **Power BI Data Analyst and Director of Research and M&E**, Adroit Associates (Apr – Jul 2025)
- **Data Analyst and Reporting Specialist**, Kudos Afghanistan (UNESCO program) (Feb – Apr 2025)
- **Quantitative Data Analysis Consultant**, Premium Performance Consulting (BMZ-funded evaluation) (Sep 2024 – Jan 2025)
- **TPM Data Analysis and Reporting Consultant**, Premium Performance Consulting (Oct – Dec 2024)
- **Quantitative and Qualitative Data Management Consultant**, Search for Common Ground (May – Dec 2024)
- **National Qualitative Data Collection and Analysis Consultant**, Itad (FCDO mine action TPM) (Nov 2023 – Mar 2024)
- **Digital Data Collection (KoBo Toolbox) Consultant**, Grant Thornton Afghanistan (UNESCO literacy TPM) (Nov 2023 – Jan 2024)

CERTIFICATIONS AND EDUCATION

- **Oracle AI Database SQL Certified Associate**, Oracle · May 2026 · verify
- **Microsoft Certified: Power BI Data Analyst Associate (PL-300)**, Microsoft · Feb 2025 · valid to Feb 2027 · verify
- **MEAL DPro (Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning)**, PM4NGOs · 2025 · verify
- **Master of Business Administration (MBA)**, Quantic School of Business and Technology · conferred July 31, 2025 · view degree
- **Diploma in Data Science**, Intellipaat · 2023

DONORS AND CLIENTS OF PROJECTS I WORKED ON

USAID, U.S. Department of Defense, U.S. Department of State, World Bank, UNDP, UNESCO, UNICEF, UNHCR, FAO, ILO, WHO, European Union, FCDO, SIDA, BMZ, Aga Khan Foundation, Save the Children, Oxfam, CARE, Islamic Relief Worldwide, DAI, Freedom House, Cordaid, Netherlands Ministry of Foreign Affairs